ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

DATE:	Monday, 13th Oct, 2025
TIME:	1:30 pm
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*
MEETING NO.	Commission Meeting No. 245
PRESENT	(1) Dasho Deki Pema,Chairperson (2) Dasho AK Rinzin, Commissioner (3) Dasho Jamtsho, Commissioner (4) Mr. Gyeltshen, Director General (5) Mrs. Kelzang Dema, Legal Officer (6) Mr. Rinchen Namgay, Head, PPD

Issue:
The recent social media coverage regarding Mr. Kelden Jamtsho, IOD, Division of Investigation's supposed Conflict of Interest (CoI) in the Economic Stimulus Programme (ESP). The writer publicly named Mr. Kelden Jamtsho and asserted that he has conflict of interest in investigating the ESP case, as he is the brother-in-law to a sitting Member of Parliament from the People's Democratic Party(PDP) and the ESP case involves the Prime Minister and the Health Minister both from the same party.

Discussed:
The Commission found the allegation of a conflict of interest is not only farfetched, baseless and without merit, but has publicly discredited the institution and its established procedures. The Commission is fully aware that the ESP case commenced as an administrative review and was later escalated to a full investigation, with Mr. Kelden Jamtsho appointed as case supervisor.

Although the Commission initially decided to maintain its focus on issues not on the one who raised it, the Commission saw the post in question quite disconcerting as it was personal and discreditable. It not only inappropriately singled out an individual officer, but also gave false impression to the public that the Commission lacked any systemic procedure within the agency thereby preemptively discrediting any investigation outcome that might contradict the allegation.

Due to such development, the Commission found it appropriate to reconsider its stance of not going after the messenger, in the interest of the institution and its hardworking officials. While the Commission did not find it necessary or appropriate at this juncture to over react and respond in public space, such unhealthy propagation of false information moulding public sentiments under the hood of anonymity cannot be ignored as doing so could potentially lead to severe and irreparable consequences. The Commission agreed that while the public opinions should be respected in the interest of promoting free speech, transparency and accountability of public institutions, it also has both moral and legal duty

to safeguard the institution from being maligned in public through unfounded allegations against its officers and systems.
Decision: The Commission decided that necessary steps should be taken to monitor the post for now but if it gets out of hand, the option to initiate a swift action that is both appropriate and lawful should not be ruled out.

13/10/25

DEKI PEMA
CHAIRPERSON

JAMTSHO

13/10/25

A KARMA RINZIN